SCHOOL COUNSELING

2018 2019

PRACTICUM HANDBOOK

COLLEGE OF EDUCATION
+ HUMAN DEVELOPMENT

UNIVERSITY OF MINNESOTA

Department of Educational Psychology
Counseling and Student Personnel Psychology

PRACTICUM HANDBOOK

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2018-2019 Edition

LETTER FROM THE DIRECTOR OF SCHOOL COUNSELING

Dear Site Supervisors,

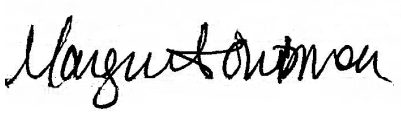
As the University of Minnesota (UMN) School Counseling Director, I wish to thank you for your willingness to assist a school counseling graduate student in their practicum experience. This handbook of information about the practicum experience, including explanations, forms, and requirements of the program, has been created for your convenience. My hope is that the handbook will help you understand the needs of the student and the UMN program during this experience.

As the University practicum instructor, I will be in weekly contact with the student or with designated practicum supervisors in the required practicum class at UMN. In addition to weekly meetings, the students are required to present taped recordings (video, if possible) of the work they are doing at your school. These tapes are reviewed during class and are confidential.

I will attempt to make a personal visit to each student's 400 hour site/school to observe the student as well as to meet with you. However, I foresee times when I will have to resort to phone calls or email because of time and numbers of students. Please know that I am open to suggestions, comments, and communication from you at any time. (Phone: 612-624-4577; email: mohrtman@umn.edu)

To show our appreciation for your generosity, your efforts, and your expertise, you will be awarded CEU's – 10 for the 150 hour site practicum supervision and 30 for the 400 hour site supervision. The CEU's will be mailed directly to you mid-May. Again, I thank you for agreeing to the interesting and demanding addition of a practicum student to your very busy school life.

Sincerely,



Marguerite Ohrtman, Ed.D., LPC, ACS, NCC
Director of School Counseling
University of Minnesota
Department of Educational Psychology
Counseling and Student Personnel Psychology
Education Science Building Room 147
mohrtman@umn.edu
612-624-4577

CONTINUING EDUCATION UNITS FOR ON-SITE SUPERVISORS

Continuing Education Units for supervision will be mailed to you following the spring semester.

150 hour practicum = 10 CEU's

Requirements and Time commitments:
1 hour per week in individual supervision with the student
Completing: Learning Objectives Contract with the student
Evaluation of the student
Conference with the student and UMN practicum instructor
Other duties:
Co-teaching with the student
Individual instruction

400 hour practicum = 30 CEU's

Requirements and Time commitments:
1 hour per week in individual supervision with the student
Completing: Learning Objectives Contract with the student
2 Evaluations of the student
Conference with the student and UMN practicum supervisor
Other duties:
Co-teaching with the student
Individual instruction

Agreement of Institutional and Program Affiliation

The University is asking that an Affiliation Agreement be signed by practicum sites. The Agreement will have been mailed to your site when you accept a practicum student. This Agreement states the responsibilities and legal liabilities of your site and the University. The Agreement will be in effect for 5 years if and when you have another practicum student. The Agreement does not require a practicum student to be at your site during the 5 yr. period.

Insurance & Immunization

All students attending the University of Minnesota are required to have health insurance and immunization records up to date.

Background Check

Students in the Counseling and Student Personnel Psychology program at the University of Minnesota have been required to complete a criminal background check.

Instruction on Confidentiality

The University certifies that its students have been instructed on the confidentiality of medical and personal information related to patients and /or clients

GENERAL PRACTICUM INFORMATION

UMN School Counseling Program

1. **Intent of Practicum**
   Practicum is the final activity in students' programs and is intended to provide them with the opportunity to engage in all the activities of a practicing school counselor in all four levels of education: kindergarten/primary, intermediate, and high school. Practicum experiences will take place at schools where the practicum student can work with clients and programs appropriate to the student's degree and licensure needs. School counseling activities occur at approved school sites and with licensed school counselors. In addition, the UMN program faculty will provide opportunity for discussion on professional issues related to the practice of school counseling through a weekly practicum class.

2. **Practicum Class**
   Practicum class is held weekly on campus. The class provides students the opportunity to discuss, question, practice, and examine school counseling issues, counseling techniques and strategies, comprehensive programs, and school counselor role and function. Six taped sessions of the students' work will be critiqued in class. Taping is confidential and completed only with written parent/ guardian permission for the group or individual sessions.

3. **Supervision**
   The site supervisor will choose, direct, and supervise the student's counseling activities. The supervisor will provide the practicum student with 1 hour of personal supervision/critiquing per week. The site supervisor must be a licensed school counselor with 2 years of school counseling experience. If you intend to work over school breaks, you must complete the Letter of Consent with your supervisor.

4. **Student Requirements**
   Students are required to complete 700 total hours of practicum experience. Of these 700 hours, 400 hours must be at the level of education where the student expects to work in the future. One hundred fifty hours of practicum experience must be completed at each of the other two levels of education, in compliance with the State of Minnesota license requirements. For example, if a student expects to be working at the high school level in the future, 400 hours of experience must be earned at the high school level, with 150 hours earned at the kindergarten/primary and 150 at the intermediate school level.

5. **Evaluation**
   The site supervisor and the UMN faculty member will complete evaluations of the practicum student. The student provides evaluation forms to the site supervisor. The forms may be completed by the supervisor in a confidential manner and mailed to the UMN faculty member, or the forms may be filled out with the student and returned to the faculty member via the student. The UMN practicum class instructor also evaluates the student on direct observation, classroom participation, and taped performances.

GUIDELINES FOR SITE SUPERVISORS

To the extent possible, the role of the site supervisor includes:

1. **Providing one hour of individual supervision per week to/for the practicum student.**

2. Providing an evaluation of the student's development and progress prior to the end of the academic term.

3. Introducing and orienting the student to the structure, programs, function, forms and procedural practices at the site.

4. Completing, with the student, a learning objectives contract identifying specific performance expectations and objectives for the practicum experience.

5. Familiarizing the student with policies and procedures regarding case management, record keeping and confidentiality, crisis team functions, abuse reporting procedures, the consulting role.

6. Orienting the student to the dynamics of the client population, including social needs and commonality of problems.

7. Affording the student the opportunity, as feasible, to identify with the supervisor as a professional practitioner by jointly participating in interviews, parent meetings, conferences, counseling sessions, classroom guidance lessons, etc.

8. Alerting the student, if necessary, to potential pitfalls involving school political realities.

9. Assigning and supervising the completion of tasks and responsibilities consistent with the student's role at the site.

10. Consulting the University practicum instructor in the event the supervisor becomes aware of personal or other issues, which are impairing the student's learning and/or performance.

11. Providing work with a caseload representing a variety of client needs.

12. Providing opportunities for decision-making and risk-taking experiences.

13. Introducing the student to the professional and support staff.

14. Orienting the student to the site policies regarding appropriate dress, office hours, scheduled meetings and conferences, individual sessions, group sessions, etc.

15. Providing opportunities for experience in four areas of school counseling: individual counseling, group counseling, classroom guidance, and parent involvement.

FOUR AREAS OF SCHOOL COUNSELING PRACTICUM EXPERIENCE

The practicum experience is designed to provide the graduate student with as many realistic experiences in a school setting as possible. The ultimate goal is to allow the student to be involved in the 4 critical areas of school counseling to the extent possible.

1. INDIVIDUAL COUNSELING

- sessions with a variety of problem issues
- sessions with a variety of types and ages of clients
- sessions with multicultural students
- familiarize with procedures and process for internal and external referral sources

2. GROUP COUNSELING

- sessions with small groups on a variety of topics
- sessions with small groups on career information
- sessions with small ongoing support groups
- arrange the formation of a group, including: interviews, parent, teacher, and administrator approval, logistics of where and when to meet, etc.

3. CLASSROOM GUIDANCE

- complete lesson plans for classroom guidance lessons
- form (possibly not complete) a unit of classroom guidance lessons
- conduct classroom guidance lessons
- conduct registration and/or career information sessions
- conduct transition sessions
- participate in registration and scheduling as needed
- participate in testing procedures/interpretations

4. PARENT INVOLVEMENT

- allow the student to observe and participate in parent conferences
- allow the student to observe parent phone conversations (with permission)
- conduct parent sessions when possible
- co-facilitate parent sessions, parent information nights, registration, etc.
- prepare parent education sessions for transition, career information, etc.

PRACTICUM SITE SELECTION PROCESS

(For Minneapolis, St. Paul, and Anoka/Osseo: see next page.)

1. The student applying for a practicum site must be currently enrolled in the UMN Master's degree program in school counseling and have met requirements for the practicum experience.

2. Students must choose a core level of education of primary interest to complete a 400 hr. practicum with 150 hrs. at the other levels: kindergarten/primary, intermediate, or high school.

3. The student must contact a licensed school counselor, working in a school, at all 3 levels of schools.

   Purpose of the contact:

   a) identify yourself, UMN, school counseling program

   b) inquire as to the possibility of being accepted for a 400 or a 150 hour practicum experience

   c) request an appointment to discuss a practicum experience to ascertain dates, times, etc.

   d) offer to provide information about the practicum requirements, for the counselor and the student – use the handbooks, supply a handbook or the website

   e) offer to provide information about yourself (resume, transcript, etc.) and be available for an interview.

   f) provide UMN contact information for the school counselor site supervisor – Dr. Marguerite Ohrtman, School Counseling Program Director: phone - 612-624-4577; email: mohrtman@umn.edu

4. The sites may all be in the same district or may be in different districts.

5. The practicum experience at the different sites may be arranged at different times throughout the school year. The recommended sequence is to complete the 400 hour site first, during the fall semester. The 400 hr. site may need to be continued into the spring semester. The other sites can be completed concurrently or sequentially in the spring semester.

6. The student will arrange the practicum site with the site supervisor who will agree to provide a supervision hour each week for the student. The student will also attend practicum class on campus for 3 hours each week for direct supervision by the instructor and group supervision by the practicum class.

PRACTICUM SITE SELECTION PROCESS

For Minneapolis, St. Paul, and Anoka/Osseo School Districts

1. The student applying for a practicum site must be currently enrolled in the Master's degree program or the Licensure-Only program in school counseling at UMN. The student must also meet the requirements for the practicum experience.

2. Students interested in practicum experiences in the Minneapolis, Saint Paul or Osseo schools must inform Dr. Marguerite Ohrtman, UMN program director, or her assistant. The student must then send a letter of intent and resume to the following district official:

Minneapolis Schools: Jim Bierma, Lead Counselor
425 5th St. N.E.
Minneapolis MN 55413
Phone: (612) 668-5478
Deadline: January 1

Saint Paul Schools: Breanna Parslow and Sue Arvidson - Lead Counselor
345 Plato Boulevard, Suite 625
St. Paul MN 55107
Phone: (651) 603-5036
Deadline: January 1

Osseo Schools: Osseo Area Schools
Student Services Department
Attn: Erin Smith
11200 93rd Ave N
Maple Grove, MN 55369
Deadline: January 19, 2019
Interview Day: February 6th, 2019

3. The selection process requires the student to send a resume and letter of intent that includes:
    a) Your program affiliation—University of Minnesota.
    b) The dates you are requesting (fall or spring)
    c) Requesting one or all 3 levels
    d) Hours at each level (e.g. kindergarten/primary150 hours, intermediate school/jr. hi 150 hours, and high school 400 hours)
    e) Possible time frame (e.g. 3 days a week in high school during fall semester)
    f) Possible schools in the district where you may have already observed
    g) Current contact information including email address, as well as summer contact information

4. The selection process will require an interview and may require a transcript.

5. Upon recommendation from the district official, the student will be assigned to a site and a site-supervisor. Decisions are usually made prior to the end of spring semester but may not be confirmed until mid-summer.
6. Students **do not** contact individual counselors for practicum sites, but may contact counselors for observation sessions. This policy is strictly observed.

7. Notify districts immediately if you find a site other than this district.

REQUIRED PRACTICUM FORMS

Form	Due Date	To Whom
Observation confirmation (EPsy 5435)	5/01 of your first year In EPsy 5435	5435 instructor
Practicum data sheet	May first of your first year	Practicum instructor
Practicum agreement Agreement of Institutional and Program Affiliation	May first of your first year	Practicum instructor
Letter of Consent For Continuing Practicum Over University Breaks	***OPTIONAL*** May first of your first year	Practicum instructor
Learning objectives contract	By the end of September	Practicum instructor
Tape permission forms	Needed with the tape	Practicum instructor
Counseling logs	Updated weekly Due at end of month	Moodle/Google Docs
Individual supervision session report	Monthly	Practicum instructor
Evaluation of practicum student (150hr)	At the end of the practicum experience	Practicum instructor Keep a copy for yourself
Evaluation of practicum student (400hr)	Mid-practicum, and at the end of the practicum experience	Practicum instructor Keep a copy for yourself
Evaluation of practicum site	At the end of each practicum experience	Practicum instructor

PRACTICUM DATA SHEET

(**Check level of major interest**)

_____ Kindergarten/Primary _____Intermediate _____ Secondary

Name:_____ Date:_____

Address:_____
(Street) (City, State, Zip Code)

Phone: (_____)_____ Email:_____

Please complete the following regarding your Practicum setting:

1. Name of School:_____

Hours to be completed at this site:_____ Fall_____ Spring_____

Days (M, T, W, Th, F) and Times (8:00-2:30) of the week at this school:_____

_____

Address of School:_____

Name of Supervising Counselor:_____

Counselor's Phone: (_____)_____ Email:_____

2. Name of School:_____

Hours to be completed at this site:_____ Fall_____Spring_____

Days (M, T, W, Th, F) and Times (8:00-2:30) of the week at this school:_____

_____

Address of School:_____

Name of Supervising Counselor:_____

Counselor's Phone: (_____)_____ Email:_____

3. Name of School:_____

Hours to be completed at this site:_____ Fall: _____Spring:_____

Days (M, T, W, Th, F) and Times (8:00-2:30) of the week at this school:_____

_____

Address of School:_____

Name of Supervising Counselor:_____

Counselor's Phone: (_____)_____ Email:_____

SCHOOL COUNSELING

PRACTICUM AGREEMENT

The Counseling and Student Personnel Psychology program of the University of Minnesota (UMN), the _____ School of School District No. _____, community of_____, Minnesota, and Mr./Ms._____, practicum student, agree to a school counseling practicum experience according to the conditions outlined by the UMN School Counseling Program. The Supervisor on-site agrees to provide one hour of individual supervision to the student per week, and the student will be allowed to audio or visually tape certain sessions with clients at the site.

Upon signatures of the practicum student, the school administrator, the supervising counselor, and the UMN counselor educator, the agreement is deemed to be in effect for the duration of the practicum experience in the _____ school year.

_____ _____
Practicum Student Date

_____ _____
Supervising Counselor Date

_____ _____
UMN Counselor Educator Date

_____ _____
K - 12 School Administrator Date

LETTER OF CONSENT

FOR CONTINUING PRACTICUM OVER UNIVERSITY BREAKS

I, _____ (site supervisor) agree to supervise _____ (practicum student) under my license over university breaks, during which period the student will not be receiving supervision from the university. I understand that this student's clinical work will be my responsibility during this time and agree to continue to provide one hour of individual supervision per week to the student.

Upon signatures of the practicum student, the site supervisor, and the University of Minnesota practicum faculty, the agreement is deemed to be in effect for the duration of the practicum experience in the _____ academic year.

_____ _____
Practicum Student Date

_____ _____
Site Supervisor Date

_____ _____
University of Minnesota Practicum Instructor Date

LEARNING OBJECTIVES CONTRACT

UMN School Counseling Program

Student:_____

Practicum Site:_____

On-Site Practicum Supervisor:_____

Supervisor's Ph. #_____ Email_____

Total hours to be completed at this site:_____

Date:_____

Learning Objectives—Practicum Supervisor:

Please identify the expectations you have for the practicum student. In your discussion with the student please identify, as specifically as possible, these expectations. These may include performance expectations or objectives that you hope to help the student accomplish while working in your school. These objectives can serve as a helpful scale by which to evaluate the student's progress. Please be as specific as possible.

1._____

_____

_____

2._____

_____

_____

3._____

_____

_____

Learning Objectives—Student:

Please identify the expectations you have for your practicum site. Before beginning your work, meet with your supervisor and discuss these objectives. These may include personal goals you hope to accomplish, experiences you hope to have, and skills you hope to gain, etc., during your work at this school. These objectives can serve as a helpful scale by which you can evaluate the practicum experience. Please be as specific as possible.

1._____

_____

_____

_____

_____

2._____

_____

_____

_____

_____

3._____

_____

_____

_____

_____

PRACTICUM TAPING EXPLANATION

Counseling and Student Personnel Psychology Program
Professional School Counseling

For a variety of reasons, practicum students are required to periodically submit examples of their counseling skills for evaluation. These examples will be submitted through an audio or visual taped session conducted at the practicum site. One reason for the taped sessions is for the site supervisor's protection and assistance. With a taped counseling session, the supervisor may verify evaluations and conclusions about the student. Another reason is to allow the UMN educator to evaluate the skill level and professionalism of the student during the practicum experience. The final reason is for the student to be able to ascertain strengths and weaknesses in his or her own counseling approach.

Permission for the taping is essential - permission from the parent, student, school supervisor, administration - according to school policy. Forms will be provided for the student and parent to sign. The form will explain the policy of the UMN practicum class and will explain confidentiality issues. The student will strictly utilize any other forms needed or required by the school district.

The focus of the taping session is totally on the graduate student and the skills displayed. The tapes will be reviewed in the practicum class at UMN, will be held in strict professional confidentiality, and will be destroyed after being critiqued.

Taped sessions of individual, group, and classroom guidance are requested. It is understood that all of these experiences may not be possible to tape, but the practicum students must be able to tape some sessions. The practicum student and UMN will strictly observe all privacy policies required by the school district.

UNIVERSITY OF MINNESOTA SCHOOL COUNSELING

TAPE PERMISSION FORM

Dear Parent/Guardian,

As part of the training of future professional school counselors, practicum students from the University of Minnesota (UMN) are required to provide evidence of their counseling skills. For the school counseling practicum students, this is their "student teaching" experience. All practicum students are supervised by your school counselor and by a professor at the university.

Practicum students at UMN are required to periodically submit examples of their counseling skills. This is done through audio or visual tapes of sessions at the practicum site. The purpose of these tapes is solely to evaluate the skills of the school counselor practicum student and to provide additional educational training for other practicum students in the class. Only the appropriate UMN professor, the practicum supervisor and the school counseling class of practicum students review the tapes.

After the tape is reviewed, it is erased. Practicum students are ethically and professionally prohibited from discussing the contents of the tape with anyone other than their supervisors and practicum classmates, unless a student client indicates that he/she is sexually or physically abused, or if a student client indicates that he/she intends to hurt him/herself or others. In these cases, practicum students, like all educators in Minnesota, are required to act on behalf of the child and report such information to the proper authorities.

Your assistance is requested in allowing us to tape a session with your child. Your child has indicated to the practicum student at school that he/she is agreeable to taping a counseling session. Your signature is needed before any taping can be done. Please sign the lower portion of this letter and send that portion with your child or by mail to your school counselor or the practicum student at your child's school. Thank you for your consideration of this request.

Name of UMN Practicum Student:_____

Name of School Counselor:_____

Permission For Taping

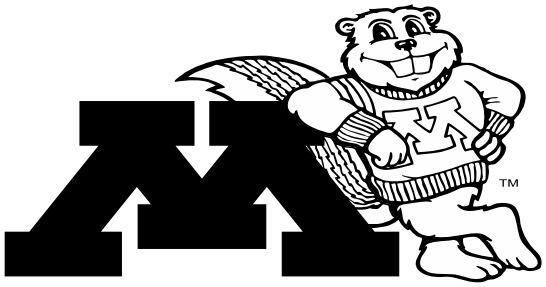
I have read the letter from University of Minnesota explaining the nature and requirements of school counseling practicum students in the School Counselor Program. I grant permission to the practicum student to tape one (1) individual session or one (1) group session with my child, for review by the UMN counselor education program and the practicum students. I understand that this tape will be used only for the training of school counselor practicum students and that it will be erased immediately after its review and evaluation.

Signature of Student:_____ Date:_____

Signature of Parent/Legal Guardian:_____ Date:_____

WEEKLY LOG

Date	*Individual Student Hours*	*Group Counseling*	*Student Activity Group*	*Parent/Guardian*	*Testing*	*Developmental Guidance*	*Other Client Contact*	*Case Management*	*Test coordination*	*Individual Supervision*	*Group Supervision (Class)*	*Staff Meetings*	*Consultation*	*Workshops/training*	*Lesson Preparation*	*Other Non-Client Contact Hour*	*Total for Day*



PRACTICUM SUMMARY SHEET

PROFESSIONAL SCHOOL COUNSELING PROGRAM

Name: _____

Site: _____

Client Contact Hours

Type of Contact	**Total Hours**
Individual Student	
Group Counseling	
Student Activity Group	
Parent/Guardian	
Testing	
Developmental Guidance	
Other	
Total	

Non-Client Contact Hours

Type of Contact	Total Hours
Case Management	
Test Coordination	
Individual Supervision	
Group Supervision	
Staff Meetings	
Consultation	
Workshops/Training	
Lesson Preparation	
Other	
Total	

Site Supervisor Signature: _____

University Supervisor Signature: _____

Student Signature: _____

Date: _____

ON-SITE INDIVIDUAL SUPERVISION SESSION REPORT

To be filled out monthly by the student and/or supervisor

Possible Subjects	Comments
Focus of the supervision session (monthly topic):	
Strengths of student (related to monthly topic):	
Areas for growth	
Follow-up for next session:	
Ethical concerns about issues at the site:	

Please Sign and Date

Supervisor **Student** **Date**

EVALUATION OF PRACTICUM STUDENT (150hrs)

School Counseling Practicum
Counseling and Student Personnel Psychology (CSPP)
University of Minnesota
150 Hour Practicum Experience

Student Name: _____ Phone: _____
Email: _____
Site Supervisor Name: _____ Phone: _____
Email: _____

Practicum Site: _____

Semester: _____ Year: _____

This counseling practicum evaluation is intended to provide: a) a tool for student self-assessment, b) feedback from the supervisor to the student, and c) data to the program faculty for discussion of progress and areas needing improvement. After reading each statement below, circle the number that best reflects your evaluation of the student's performance.

Please rate the student's performance using the following scale: 1 = Below average, 2 = Average, 3 = Above average, 4 = Excellent, N = No basis for observation

Counseling Process/Skills/Case Conceptualization

1 2 3 4 N	1. Establishes and maintains confidential boundaries.
1 2 3 4 N	2. Quickly builds rapport.
1 2 3 4 N	3. Uses basic helping skills appropriately (silence, questions, reflection of feelings and content, clarifying and paraphrasing of responses).
1 2 3 4 N	4. Uses advanced helping skills appropriately (confrontation, interpretation, self-disclosure, referrals, etc.).
1 2 3 4 N	5. Explains, administers, and interprets assessment instruments effectively.
1 2 3 4 N	6. Conceptualizes client concerns/formulates clinical hypotheses.
1 2 3 4 N	**7.** Works with the client to establish counseling/helping goals.
1 2 3 4 N	8. Works with the client toward achieving counseling/helping goals.
1 2 3 4 N	9. Maintains professional boundaries with students.

1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**N**	10. Terminates counseling relationship effectively.
					Professional Attitude and Behavior
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**N**	11. Uses supervision (comes prepared, seeks out feedback and learning opportunities).
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**N**	12. Is open and responsive to feedback.
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**N**	13. Engages in open and clear communication with peers and supervisors.
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**N**	14. Recognizes the boundaries of his/her competencies.
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**N**	15. Demonstrates a personal commitment to develop professional competencies.
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**N**	16. Demonstrates awareness and openness to diversity issues, which may affect professional interaction with clients, peers, supervisors, and staff members.
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**N**	17. Is punctual and keeps appointments.
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**N**	18. Completes case records in a timely and accurate manner.
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**N**	19. Demonstrates ethical and legal behavior in counseling, case management, and supervision.
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**N**	20. Has an accurate perception of his/her strengths and limitations.
					Working in the School Setting
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**N**	21. Conducts classroom guidance and teaching activities.
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**N**	22. Assists students with educational and career decision-making through individual and/or group counseling and/or classroom guidance.
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**N**	23. Conducts administrative tasks (scheduling, class changes, etc.).
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**N**	24. Demonstrates appropriate consultation skills with parents, teachers, administrators, and counselors.
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**N**	25. Coordinates referrals to school psychologists, nurses, social workers, and community providers.
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**N**	26. Works effectively with staff members.

1 2 3 4 N	27. Follows the policies and procedures of the school site and the school district.
	Overall Evaluation
1 2 3 4	28. Your overall evaluation of the student's level of performance this semester.

Comments: (Please list at least two of the student's major strengths and two areas for improvement.)

Strengths:
1)

2)

Improvement:
1)

2)

Signatures please:
Date: _____ Student: _____

Date:_____ Site Supervisor_____

Date:_____ Practicum Supervisor: _____

EVALUATION OF PRACTICUM STUDENT (400hrs)

School Counseling Practicum
Counseling and Student Personnel Psychology (CSPP)
University of Minnesota
400 Hour Practicum Experience

Student Name: _____ Phone: _____
Email: _____
Site Supervisor Name: _____ Phone: _____

Email: _____

Practicum Site: _____

Semester: _____ Year: _____

This counseling practicum evaluation is intended to provide: a) a tool for student self-assessment, b) feedback from the supervisor to the student, and c) data to the program faculty for discussion of progress and areas needing improvement. After reading each statement below, circle the number that best reflects your evaluation of the student's performance.

Please rate the student's performance using the following scale: 1 = Below average, 2 = Average, 3 = Above average, 4 = Excellent, N = No basis for observation

Mid-Practicum Progress	**COUNSELING SKILLS**	***Final Evaluation***
1 2 3 4 N	1. Establishes and maintains confidential boundaries.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	2. Quickly builds rapport.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	3. Uses basic helping skills appropriately (silence, questions, reflection of feelings and content, clarifying and paraphrasing of responses).	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	4. Uses advanced helping skills appropriately (confrontation, interpretation, self-disclosure, referrals, etc.).	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	5. Explains, administers, and interprets assessment instruments effectively.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	6. Conceptualizes client concerns/formulates clinical hypotheses.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	7. Works with the client to establish counseling/helping goals.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	8. Works with the client toward achieving counseling/helping goals.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	9. Maintains professional boundaries with students.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	10. Terminates counseling relationship effectively.	1 2 3 4 N
	Professional Attitude and Behavior	
1 2 3 4 N	11. Uses supervision (comes prepared, seeks out feedback and learning opportunities).	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	12. Is open and responsive to feedback.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	13. Engages in open and clear communication with peers and supervisors.	1 2 3 4 N

1 2 3 4 N	14. Recognizes the boundaries of his/her competencies.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	15. Demonstrates a personal commitment to develop professional competencies.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	16. Demonstrates awareness and openness to diversity issues which may affect professional interaction with clients, peers, supervisors, and staff members.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	17. Is punctual and keeps appointments.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	18. Completes case records in a timely and accurate manner.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	19. Demonstrates ethical and legal behavior in counseling, case management, and supervision.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	20. Has an accurate perception of his/her strengths and limitations.	1 2 3 4 N
	Working in the School Setting	
1 2 3 4 N	21. Conducts classroom guidance and teaching activities.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	22. Assists students with educational and career decision-making through individual and/or group counseling and/or classroom guidance.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	23. Conducts administrative tasks (scheduling, class changes, etc.).	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	24. Demonstrates appropriate consultation skills with parents, teachers, administrators, and counselors.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	25. Coordinates referrals to school psychologists, nurses, social workers, and community providers.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	26. Works effectively with staff members.	1 2 3 4 N
1 2 3 4 N	27. Follows the policies and procedures of the school site and the school district.	1 2 3 4 N
	Overall Evaluation	
1 2 3 4	28. Your overall evaluation of the student's level of performance this semester.	1 2 3 4

NARRATIVE COMMENTS

MID-PRACTICUM PROGRESS REPORT	FINAL EVALUATION
1. Counseling strengths:	1. Counseling strengths:

2. Areas needing improvement:

2. Areas needing improvement:

3. Overall evaluation of student's performance function independently:

3. Overall evaluation of student's performance and ability to function independently:

4. How might the practicum experience be for the student and/or the site?

4. How might the practicum experience be improved for the student and/or the site?

Signatures please:

Date: _____ Site Supervisor_____

Date: _____ Practicum Supervisor: _____

EVALUATION OF PRACTICUM SITE

UMN School Counseling Program

Student Name: _____Date:_____

Site Supervisor Name:_____

Practicum Site (School name/City name):_____

_____

Would you recommend this site to others?_____ Overall rating (1-10):_____

****These evaluations will be available to other students to assist them in choosing a practicum site****

PLEASE CIRCLE THE NUMBER THAT BEST CORRESPONDS TO YOUR PERCEPTIONS.

1. Did not know what Adequate and accurate practicum

	to expect from my practicum setting.				information available; knew what to expect.
	1	2	3	4	5
2.	No orientation received from supervisor or other staff.				Good orientation from all those concerned with my practicum experience.
	1	2	3	4	5
3.	Expectations and supervisory promises were not obtained from the practicum experience.				Expectation and supervisory promises were well obtained.
	1	2	3	4	5
4.	Too little time to accomplish all learning desired.				Ample time to accomplish and learn.
	1	2	3	4	5
5.	Much time spent was wasted and/or managed poorly.				Little or no time was wasted.
	1	2	3	4	5
6.	My supervisor was not often available, which left me without guidance or support in many instances.				My supervisor was always available for guidance, help, case conferences or suggestions.
	1	2	3	4	5
7.	Too much responsibility was placed on me without adequate preparation being allowed on my part.				Adequate preparation and opportunity for assuming responsibility was built into the experience.
	1	2	3	4	5
8.	No freedom to exercise own judgment or try out ideas.				Able to freely exercise own judgment in trying out ideas.
	1	2	3	4	5
9.	Supervisor did not share opinions and ideas on professional issues.				Supervisor fully shared opinions and ideas on professional issues.
	1	2	3	4	5
10.	Received no evaluation feedback of my strengths and weaknesses.				Gained a much better understanding of my strengths and weaknesses.

1 2 3 4 5

11. Received no feedback from on-the-job performance. Received ample and appropriate feedback from supervisor on my on-the-job performance.

1 2 3 4 5

12. Felt treated as an outsider isolated from ongoing activities. Viewed as a professional, an equal, a colleague on the staff.

1 2 3 4 5

13. No opportunity for contact with other staff members. Frequent and helpful contact with many staff members.

1 2 3 4 5

14. Staff members not willing to work with me in areas where I needed extra help. Staff members were quite willing to spend extra time to train or teach me.

1 2 3 4 5

15. No opportunity for contact with staff from other offices. Frequent contact with staff members from other offices.

1 2 3 4 5

16. No real opportunity to observe professional role models within practical work setting. Ample opportunity to observe role models representing the full range of professional activity and behavior.

1 2 3 4 5

17. No opportunity to observe professional role models of my own sex within the practical work setting. Ample opportunity to observe professional role models of my own sex within the practical work setting.

1 2 3 4 5

18. No opportunity to become involved with the different functions within assignment area. Ample opportunity to become involved in many different types of functions within the assignment area.

1 2 3 4 5

19. No direct contact with clients within the work. Ample opportunity to become directly involved with clients.

1 2 3 4 5

20. No exposure to, or opportunity to learn more about available resources within the office. Ample exposure to available resources and their uses within the office.

1 2 3 4 5

21. No exposure or opportunity to work with other resource facilities or personnel outside the office. Encouragement and opportunity to work with outside resource personnel and facilities.

1 2 3 4 5

22. Professional ethics were neither discussed nor exemplified within the practical work setting. Professional ethics were discussed and exemplified within the practical work setting.

1 2 3 4 5

23. Discrimination problems (sex, race, etc.) were not dealt with in practical work setting. Problems of discrimination appeared to be handled adequately within the practical work setting.

1 2 3 4 5

24. There was no clear structure or direction to the experience. The experience was structured in such a way as to promote learning.

1 2 3 4 5

25. I observed or acquired few or limited competencies or skills. I was exposed to and had opportunity to develop a wide range of competencies and skills.

1 2 3 4 5

26. Had no opportunity to achieve my personal objectives as established at beginning of practical experience. Had ample opportunity to achieve my personal objectives as established at the beginning of practical experience.

1 2 3 4 5

27. I was totally dissatisfied with practicum experience. Completely satisfied with practicum experience.

1 2 3 4 5

28. As a result of the practicum experience I feel discouraged As a result of the practicum experience I have been highly

about both the state of the profession and my place in it.

motivated and encouraged about entering the profession.

1 2 3 4 5

Suggestions for improving this practicum experience:

What would you have liked to known before you applied to this site?

K-12 SCHOOL COUNSELOR LICENSING PROCEDURES

You are responsible for completing the online application when your degree has been conferred on your transcript (usually two weeks after graduation). The documents that **must** be sent to Dr. Marguerite Ohrtman include: **online application cover sheet, fingerprint card, official transcripts, and verification form of a state-approved preparation program.**

Step 1 Apply for your MN license with Minnesota Professional Educator Licensing and Standards Board (PELSB)

- Open your account with PELSB online application system (must use a Google Account, or your U of M email should work) https://w1.education.state.mn.us/CELApplication/
- Proceed with Online application, and enter all required information.
- Pay the fee by credit card – Pay the amount specified for the license application.

Step 2 Print out the following two documents off your PELSB online application account

- License Application Cover Page/Document Checklist from Minnesota Processional Educator Licensing and Standards Board (PELSB) online application
- Verification of Completion of a State-Approved Licensure Program form (ED# 02414-05) from the PELSB online application

Download the Verification form by clicking on the link [Click to Download Form ED # 02414] on the License Application Cover Page/Document Checklist and print it out.

- Verification of Completion of a State-Approved Licensure Program form (see Step 2 above). ***Be sure the section titled: Student Teaching/Practicum/Internship Experience is completed on this form.***
- PELSB Fingerprint card (see Step 3 above)
- Signed and dated Transcript Release Form http://www.cehd.umn.edu/assets/docs/teaching/licensing/MDE-transcript-release-form.pdf
- If you have a foreign/international undergraduate degree you must have a NACES approved member organization complete a course-by-course evaluation of your international transcript. Here is the link to NACES web site http://www.naces.org/members.html. international.

Note: It takes approximately 2 to 3 weeks for the MA degree status to appear on a transcript after the end of the semester. Do not send transcripts until the degree has been conferred on the transcript. If school districts require the license for interviews, job applications, or contracts, Dr. Marguerite Orhtman will write an eligibility letter upon request of the student.

(Adopted 1984; revised 1992, 1998, 2004 and 2010, 2016)

Preamble

The American School Counselor Association (ASCA) is a professional organization supporting school counselors, school counseling students/interns, school counseling program directors/supervisors and school counselor educators. School coun-selors have unique qualifications and skills to address preK–12 students' academic, career and social/emotional development needs. These standards are the ethical responsibility of all school counseling professionals.

School counselors are advocates, leaders, collaborators and consultants who create systemic change by providing equitable educational access and success by connecting their school counseling programs to the district's mission and improvement plans. School counselors demonstrate their belief that all students have the ability to learn by advocating for an education system that provides optimal learning environments for all students.

All students have the right to:

8. Be respected, be treated with dignity and have access to a comprehensive school counseling program that advocates for and affirms all students from diverse populations including but not limited to: ethnic/racial identity, nationality, age, social class, economic status, abilities/disabilities, language, immigration status, sexual orientation, gender, gender identity/expression, family type, religious/spiritual identity, emancipated minors, wards of the state, homeless youth and incarcerated youth. School counselors as social-justice advocates support students from all backgrounds and circumstances and consult when their competence level requires additional support.
9. Receive the information and support needed to move toward self-determination, self-development and affirmation within one's group identities. Special care is given to improve overall educational outcomes for students who have been historically underserved in educational services.
10. Receive critical, timely information on college, career and postsecondary options and understand the full magnitude and meaning of how college and career readiness can have an impact on their educational choices and future opportunities.
11. Privacy that should be honored to the greatest extent possible, while balancing other competing interests (e.g., best interests of students, safety of others, parental rights) and adhering to laws, policies and ethical standards pertaining to confidentiali-ty and disclosure in the school setting.
12. A safe school environment promoting autonomy and justice and free from abuse, bullying, harassment and other forms of violence.

PURPOSE

In this document, ASCA specifies the obligation to the principles of ethical behavior necessary to maintain the high standards of integrity, leadership and professionalism. The ASCA Ethical Standards for School Counselors were developed in consulta-tion with state school counseling associations, school counselor educators, school counseling state and district leaders and school counselors across the nation to clarify the norms, values and beliefs of the profession.

The purpose of this document is to:

11. Serve as a guide for the ethical practices of all school counsel-ors, supervisors/directors of school counseling programs and school counselor educators regardless of level, area, popula-tion served or membership in this professional association.

12. Provide support and direction for self-assessment, peer consul-tation and evaluations regarding school counselors' responsi-bilities to students, parents/guardians, colleagues and profes-sional associates, schools district employees, communities and the school counseling profession.

13. Inform all stakeholders, including students, parents/guardians, teachers, administrators, community members and courts of justice of best ethical practices, values and expected behaviors of the school counseling professional.

A. RESPONSIBILITY TO STUDENTS

A.1. Supporting Student Development

School counselors:

a. Have a primary obligation to the students, who are to be treated with dignity and respect as unique individuals.

b. Aim to provide counseling to students in a brief context and support students and families/guardians in obtaining outside services if the student needs long-term clinical counseling.

c. Do not diagnose but remain acutely aware of how a student's diagnosis can potentially affect the student's academic success.

d. Acknowledge the vital role of parents/guardians and families.

e. Are concerned with students' academic, career and social/ emotional needs and encourage each student's maximum devel-opment.

f. Respect students' and families' values, beliefs, sexual orienta-tion, gender identification/expression and cultural background and exercise great care to avoid imposing personal beliefs or values rooted in one's religion, culture or ethnicity.

g. Are knowledgeable of laws, regulations and policies affecting students and families and strive to protect and inform students and families regarding their rights.

h. Provide effective, responsive interventions to address student needs.

i. Consider the involvement of support networks, wraparound services and educational teams needed to best serve students.

j. Maintain appropriate boundaries and are aware that any sexual or romantic relationship with students whether legal or illegal in the state of practice is considered a grievous breach of ethics and is prohibited regardless of a student's age. This prohibition applies to both in-person and electronic interactions and relationships.

A.2. Confidentiality

School counselors:

a. Promote awareness of school counselors' ethical standards and legal mandates regarding confidentiality and the appropri-ate rationale and procedures for disclosure of student data and information to school staff.

b. Inform students of the purposes, goals, techniques and rules of procedure under which they may receive counseling. Disclo-sure includes informed consent and clarification of the limits of confidentiality. Informed consent requires competence, volun-tariness and knowledge on the part of students to understand the limits of confidentiality and, therefore, can be difficult to ob-tain from students of certain developmental levels, English-lan-guage learners and special-needs populations. If the student is able to give assent/consent before school counselors share confidential information, school counselors attempt to gain the student's assent/consent.

c. Are aware that even though attempts are made to obtain informed consent, it is not always possible. When needed, school counselors make counseling decisions on students' behalf that promote students' welfare.

d. Explain the limits of confidentiality in developmentally appro-priate terms through multiple methods such as student hand-books, school counselor department websites, school counseling brochures, classroom curriculum and/or verbal notification to individual students.

e. Keep information confidential unless legal requirements demand that confidential information be revealed or a breach is required to prevent serious and foreseeable harm to the stu-dent. Serious and foreseeable harm is different for each minor in schools and is determined by students' developmental and chronological age, the setting, parental rights and the nature of the harm. School counselors consult with appropriate profes-sionals when in doubt as to the validity of an exception.

f. Recognize their primary ethical obligation for confidentiality is to the students but balance that obligation with an under-standing of parents'/guardians' legal and inherent rights to be the guiding voice in their children's lives. School counselors understand the need to balance students' ethical rights to make choices, their capacity to give consent or assent, and parental or familial legal rights and responsibilities to make decisions on their child's behalf.

g. Promote the autonomy of students to the extent possible and use the most appropriate and least intrusive method to breach confidentiality, if such action is warranted. The child's develop-mental age and the circumstances requiring the breach are con-sidered, and as appropriate, students are engaged in a discussion about the method and timing of the breach. Consultation with peers and/or supervision is recommended.

h. In absence of state legislation expressly forbidding disclosure, consider the ethical responsibility to provide information to an identified third party who, by his/her relationship with the student, is at a high risk of contracting a disease that is com-monly known to be communicable and fatal. Disclosure requires satisfaction of all of the following conditions:

13. Student identifies partner, or the partner is highly identifi-able
14. School counselor recommends the student notify partner and refrain from further high-risk behavior
15. Student refuses
16. School counselor informs the student of the intent to noti-fy the partner
17. School counselor seeks legal consultation from the school district's legal representative in writing as to the legalities of informing the partner

i. Request of the court that disclosure not be required when the school counselor's testimony or case notes are subpoenaed if the release of confidential information may potentially harm a student or the counseling relationship.

j. Protect the confidentiality of students' records and release per-sonal data in accordance with prescribed federal and state laws and school board policies.

k. Recognize the vulnerability of confidentiality in electronic communications and only transmit student information electron-ically in a way that follows currently accepted security standards and meets federal, state and local laws and board policy.

l. Convey a student's highly sensitive information (e.g., a student's suicidal ideation) through personal contact such as a phone call or visit and not less-secure means such as a notation in the educational record or an e-mail. Adhere to state, federal and school board policy when conveying sensitive information.

m. Advocate for appropriate safeguards and protocols so highly sensitive student information is not disclosed accidentally to individuals who do not have a need to know such information. Best practice suggests a very limited number of educators would have access to highly sensitive information on a need-to-know basis.

n. Advocate with appropriate school officials for acceptable encryption standards to be utilized for stored data and currently acceptable algorithms to be utilized for data in transit.

o. Avoid using software programs without the technological capabilities to protect student information based upon currently acceptable security standards and the law.

A.3. Comprehensive Data-Informed Program

School counselors:

a. Collaborate with administration, teachers, staff and decision makers around school-improvement goals.

b. Provide students with a comprehensive school counseling program that ensures equitable academic, career and social/ emotional development opportunities for all students.

c. Review school and student data to assess needs including, but not limited to, data on disparities that may exist related to gen-der, race, ethnicity, socio-economic status and/or other relevant classifications.

d. Use data to determine needed interventions, which are then delivered to help close the information, attainment, achievement and opportunity gaps.

e. Collect process, perception and outcome data and analyze the data to determine the progress and effectiveness of the school counseling program. School counselors ensure the school counseling program's goals and action plans are aligned with district's school improvement goals.

f. Use data-collection tools adhering to confidentiality standards as expressed in A.2.

g. Share data outcomes with stakeholders.

A.4. Academic, Career and Social/Emotional Plans

School counselors:

a. Collaborate with administration, teachers, staff and decision makers to create a culture of postsecondary readiness

b. Provide and advocate for individual students' preK–postsecondary college and career awareness, exploration and postsecondary planning and decision making, which supports the students' right to choose from the wide array of options when students complete secondary education.

c. Identify gaps in college and career access and the implications of such data for addressing both intentional and unintentional biases related to college and career counseling.

d. Provide opportunities for all students to develop the mindsets and behaviors necessary to learn work-related skills, resilience, perseverance, an understanding of lifelong learning as a part of long-term career success, a positive attitude toward learning and a strong work ethic.

A.5. Dual Relationships and Managing Boundaries

School counselors:

a. Avoid dual relationships that might impair their objectivity and increase the risk of harm to students (e.g., counseling one's family members or the children of close friends or associates). If a dual relationship is unavoidable, the school counselor is responsible for taking action to eliminate or reduce the poten-tial for harm to the student through use of safeguards, which might include informed consent, consultation, supervision and documentation.

b. Establish and maintain appropriate professional relationships with students at all times. School counselors consider the risks and benefits of extending current school counseling relationships beyond conventional parameters, such as attending a student's distant athletic competition. In extending these boundaries, school counselors take appropriate professional precautions such as informed consent, consultation and supervision. School counselors document the nature of interactions that extend beyond conventional parameters, including the rationale for the interaction, the potential benefit and the possible positive and negative consequences for the student and school counselor.

c. Avoid dual relationships beyond the professional level with school personnel, parents/guardians and students' other family members when these relationships might infringe on the integrity of the school counselor/student relationship. Inappropriate dual relationships include, but are not limited to, providing direct discipline, teaching courses that involve grading students and/ or accepting administrative duties in the absence of an adminis-trator.

d. Do not use personal social media, personal e-mail accounts or personal texts to interact with students unless specifically encouraged and sanctioned by the school district. School coun-selors adhere to professional boundaries and legal, ethical and school district guidelines when using technology with students, parents/guardians or school staff. The technology utilized, including, but not limited to, social networking sites or apps, should be endorsed by the school district and used for profes-sional communication and the distribution of vital information.

A.6. Appropriate Referrals and Advocacy

School counselors:

a. Collaborate with all relevant stakeholders, including students, educators and parents/guardians when student assistance is needed, including the identification of early warning signs of student distress.

b. Provide a list of resources for outside agencies and resources in their community to student(s) and parents/guardians when students need or request additional support. School counselors provide multiple referral options or the district's vetted list and are careful not to indicate an endorsement or preference for one counselor or practice. School counselors encourage parents to interview outside professionals to make a personal decision regarding the best source of assistance for their student.

c. Connect students with services provided through the local school district and community agencies and remain aware of state laws and local district policies related to students with special needs, including limits to confidentiality and notification to authorities as appropriate.

d. Develop a plan for the transitioning of primary counseling services with minimal interruption of services. Students retain the right for the referred services to be done in coordination with the school counselor or to discontinue counseling services with the school counselor while maintaining an appropriate relationship that may include providing other school support services.

e. Refrain from referring students based solely on the school counselor's personal beliefs or values rooted in one's religion, culture, ethnicity or personal worldview. School counselors

maintain the highest respect for student diversity. School coun-selors should pursue additional training and supervision in areas where they are at risk of imposing their values on students, es-pecially when the school counselor's values are discriminatory in nature. School counselors do not impose their values on students and/or families when making referrals to outside resources for student and/or family support.

f. Attempt to establish a collaborative relationship with outside service providers to best serve students. Request a release of in-formation signed by the student and/or parents/guardians before attempting to collaborate with the student's external provider.

g. Provide internal and external service providers with accurate, objective, meaningful data necessary to adequately evaluate, counsel and assist the student.

h. Ensure there is not a conflict of interest in providing referral resources. School counselors do not refer or accept a referral to counsel a student from their school if they also work in a private counseling practice.

A.7. Group Work

School counselors:

a. Facilitate short-term groups to address students' academic, career and/or social/emotional issues.

b. Inform parent/guardian(s) of student participation in a small group.

c. Screen students for group membership.

d. Use data to measure member needs to establish well-defined expectations of group members.

e. Communicate the aspiration of confidentiality as a group norm, while recognizing and working from the protective posture that confidentiality for minors in schools cannot be guaranteed.

f. Select topics for groups with the clear understanding that some topics are not suitable for groups in schools and accord-ingly take precautions to protect members from harm as a result of interactions with the group.

g. Facilitate groups from the framework of evidence-based or research-based practices.

h. Practice within their competence level and develop profession-al competence through training and supervision.

i. Measure the outcomes of group participation (process, percep-tion and outcome data).

j. Provide necessary follow up with group members.

A.8. Student Peer-Support Program

School counselors:

a. Safeguard the welfare of students participating in peer-to-peer programs under their direction.

b. Supervise students engaged in peer helping, mediation and other similar peer-support groups. School counselors are respon-sible for appropriate skill development for students serving as peer support in school counseling programs. School counselors continuously monitor students who are giving peer support and reinforce the confidential nature of their work. School counsel-ors inform peer-support students about the parameters of when students need to report information to responsible adults.

A.9. Serious and Foreseeable Harm to Self and Others

School counselors:

a. Inform parents/guardians and/or appropriate authorities when a student poses a serious and foreseeable risk of harm to self or others. When feasible, this is to be done after careful delib-eration and consultation with other appropriate professionals. School counselors inform students of the school counselor's legal and ethical obligations to report the concern to the appropriate authorities unless it is appropriate to withhold this information to protect the student (e.g. student might run away if he/she knows parents are being called). The consequence of the risk of not giving parents/guardians a chance to intervene on behalf of their child is too great. Even if the danger appears relatively remote, parents should be notified.

b. Use risk assessments with caution. If risk assessments are used by the school counselor, an intervention plan should be developed and in place prior to this practice. When reporting risk-assessment results to parents, school counselors do not negate the risk of harm even if the assessment reveals a low risk as students may minimize risk to avoid further scrutiny and/or parental notification. School counselors report risk assessment results to parents to underscore the need to act on behalf of a child at risk; this is not intended to assure parents their child isn't at risk, which is something a school counselor cannot know with certainty.

c. Do not release a student who is a danger to self or others until the student has proper and necessary support. If parents will not provide proper support, the school counselor takes neces-sary steps to underscore to parents/guardians the necessity to seek help and at times may include a report to child protective services.

d. Report to parents/guardians and/or appropriate authorities when students disclose a perpetrated or a perceived threat to their physical or mental well-being. This threat may include, but is not limited to, physical abuse, sexual abuse, neglect, dating violence, bullying or sexual harassment. The school counsel-or follows applicable federal, state and local laws and school district policy.

A.10. Underserved and At-Risk Populations

School counselors:

a. Strive to contribute to a safe, respectful, nondiscriminatory school environment in which all members of the school commu-nity demonstrate respect and civility.

b. Advocate for and collaborate with students to ensure students remain safe at home and at school. A high standard of care includes determining what information is shared with parents/ guardians and when information creates an unsafe environment for students.

c. Identify resources needed to optimize education.

d. Collaborate with parents/guardians, when appropriate, to establish communication and to ensure students' needs are met.

e. Understand students have the right to be treated in a manner consistent with their gender identity and to be free from any form of discipline, harassment or discrimination based on their gender identity or gender expression.

f. Advocate for the equal right and access to free, appropri-ate public education for all youth, in which students are not stigmatized or isolated based on their housing status, disability, foster care, special education status, mental health or any other exceptionality or special need.

g. Recognize the strengths of students with disabilities as well as their challenges and provide best practices and current research in supporting their academic, career and social/emotional needs.

A.11. Bullying, Harassment and Child Abuse

School counselors:

a. Report to the administration all incidents of bullying, dating violence and sexual harassment as most fall under Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 or other federal and state laws as being illegal and require administrator interventions. School counselors provide services to victims and perpetrator as appropriate, which may include a safety plan and reasonable accommodations such as schedule change, but school counselors defer to administration for all discipline issues for this or any other federal, state or school board violation.

b. Report suspected cases of child abuse and neglect to the prop-er authorities and take reasonable precautions to protect the privacy of the student for whom abuse or neglect is suspected when alerting the proper authorities.

c. Are knowledgeable about current state laws and their school system's procedures for reporting child abuse and neglect and methods to advocate for students' physical and emotional safety following abuse/neglect reports.

d. Develop and maintain the expertise to recognize the signs and indicators of abuse and neglect. Encourage training to enable students and staff to have the knowledge and skills needed to recognize the signs of abuse and neglect and to whom they should report suspected abuse or neglect.

e. Guide and assist students who have experienced abuse and neglect by providing appropriate services.

A.12. Student Records

School counselors:

a. Abide by the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA), which defines who has access to students' educational records and allows parents the right to review and challenge perceived inaccuracies in their child's records.

b. Advocate for the ethical use of student data and records and inform administration of inappropriate or harmful practices.

c. Recognize the difficulty in meeting the criteria of sole-possession records.

d. Recognize that sole-possession records and case notes can be subpoenaed unless there is a specific state statute for privileged communication expressly protecting student/school counselor communication.

e. Recognize that electronic communications with school offi-cials regarding individual students, even without using student names, are likely to create student records that must be ad-dressed in accordance with FERPA and state laws.

f. Establish a reasonable timeline for purging sole-possession records or case notes. Suggested guidelines include shredding pa-per sole-possession records or deleting electronic sole-possession records when a student transitions to the next level, transfers to another school or graduates. School counselors do not destroy sole-possession records that may be needed by a court of law, such as notes on child abuse, suicide, sexual harassment or vio-lence, without prior review and approval by school district legal counsel. School counselors follow district policies and proce-dures when contacting legal counsel.

A.13. Evaluation, Assessment and Interpretation

School counselors:

a. Use only valid and reliable tests and assessments with concern for bias and cultural sensitivity.

b. Adhere to all professional standards when selecting, admin-istering and interpreting assessment measures and only utilize assessment measures that are within the scope of practice for school counselors and for which they are licensed, certified and competent.

c. Are mindful of confidentiality guidelines when utilizing paper or electronic evaluative or assessment instruments and pro-grams.

d. Consider the student's developmental age, language skills and level of competence when determining the appropriateness of an assessment.

e. Use multiple data points when possible to provide students and families with accurate, objective and concise information to promote students' well-being.

f. Provide interpretation of the nature, purposes, results and potential impact of assessment/evaluation measures in language the students and parents/guardians can understand.

g. Monitor the use of assessment results and interpretations and take reasonable steps to prevent others from misusing the information.

h. Use caution when utilizing assessment techniques, making evaluations and interpreting the performance of populations not represented in the norm group on which an instrument is standardized.

i. Conduct school counseling program evaluations to determine the effectiveness of activities supporting students' academic, career and social/emotional development through accountabil-ity measures, especially examining efforts to close information, opportunity and attainment gaps.

A.14. Technical and Digital Citizenship

School counselors:

a. Demonstrate appropriate selection and use of technology and software applications to enhance students' academic, career and social/emotional development. Attention is given to the ethical and legal considerations of technological applications, including confidentiality concerns, security issues, potential limitations and benefits and communication practices in electronic media.

b. Take appropriate and reasonable measures for maintaining confidentiality of student information and educational records stored or transmitted through the use of computers, social media, facsimile machines, telephones, voicemail, answering machines and other electronic technology.

c. Promote the safe and responsible use of technology in collaboration with educators and families.

d. Promote the benefits and clarify the limitations of various appropriate technological applications.

e. Use established and approved means of communication with students, maintaining appropriate boundaries. School counselors help educate students about appropriate communication and boundaries.

f. Advocate for equal access to technology for all students.

A.15. Virtual/Distance School Counseling

School counselors:

a. Adhere to the same ethical guidelines in a virtual/distance setting as school counselors in face-to-face settings.

b. Recognize and acknowledge the challenges and limitations of virtual/distance school counseling.

c. Implement procedures for students to follow in both emergen-cy and nonemergency situations when the school counselor is not available.

d. Recognize and mitigate the limitation of virtual/distance school counseling confidentiality, which may include unintended viewers or recipients.

e. Inform both the student and parent/guardian of the benefits and limitations of virtual/distance counseling.

f. Educate students on how to participate in the electronic school counseling relationship to minimize and prevent potential misunderstandings that could occur due to lack of verbal cues and inability to read body language or other visual cues that provide contextual meaning to the school counseling process and school counseling relationship.

B. RESPONSIBILITIES TO PARENTS/ GUARDIANS, SCHOOL AND SELF

B.1. Responsibilities to Parents/Guardians

School counselors:

a. Recognize that providing services to minors in a school setting requires school counselors to collaborate with students' parents/ guardians as appropriate.

b. Respect the rights and responsibilities of custodial and noncustodial parents/guardians and, as appropriate, establish a collaborative relationship with parents/guardians to facilitate students' maximum development.

c. Adhere to laws, local guidelines and ethical practice when assisting parents/guardians experiencing family difficulties interfering with the student's welfare.

d. Are culturally competent and sensitive to diversity among families. Recognize that all parents/guardians, custodial and noncustodial, are vested with certain rights and responsibilities for their children's welfare by virtue of their role and according to law.

e. Inform parents of the mission of the school counseling program and program standards in academic, career and social/ emotional domains that promote and enhance the learning process for all students.

f. Inform parents/guardians of the confidential nature of the school counseling relationship between the school counselor and student.

g. Respect the confidentiality of parents/guardians as appropri-ate and in accordance with the student's best interests.

h. Provide parents/guardians with accurate, comprehensive and relevant information in an objective and caring manner, as is appropriate and consistent with ethical and legal responsibilities to the student and parent.

i. In cases of divorce or separation, follow the directions and stipulations of the legal documentation, maintaining focus on the student. School counselors avoid supporting one parent over another.

B.2. Responsibilities to the School

School counselors:

a. Develop and maintain professional relationships and systems of communication with faculty, staff and administrators to support students.

b. Design and deliver comprehensive school counseling pro-grams that are integral to the school's academic mission; driven by student data; based on standards for academic, career and social/emotional development; and promote and enhance the learning process for all students.

c. Advocate for a school counseling program free of non-school-counseling assignments identified by "The ASCA National Model: A Framework for School Counseling Pro-grams" as inappropriate to the school counselor's role.

d. Provide leadership to create systemic change to enhance the school.

e. Collaborate with appropriate officials to remove barriers that may impede the effectiveness of the school or the school counsel-ing program.

f. Provide support, consultation and mentoring to professionals in need of assistance when in the scope of the school counselor's role.

g. Inform appropriate officials, in accordance with school board policy, of conditions that may be potentially disruptive or

damaging to the school's mission, personnel and property while honoring the confidentiality between the student and the school counselor to the extent feasible, consistent with applicable law and policy.

h. Advocate for administrators to place in school counseling positions certified school counselors who are competent, qualified and hold a master's degree or higher in school counseling from an accredited program.

i. Advocate for equitable school counseling program policies and practices for all students and stakeholders.

j. Strive to use translators who have been vetted or reviewed and bilingual/multilingual school counseling program materials representing languages used by families in the school community.

k. Affirm the abilities of and advocate for the learning needs of all students. School counselors support the provision of appro-priate accommodations and accessibility.

l. Provide workshops and written/digital information to families to increase understanding, improve communication and promote student achievement.

m. Promote cultural competence to help create a safer more inclusive school environment.

n. Adhere to educational/psychological research practices, confidentiality safeguards, security practices and school district policies when conducting research.

o. Promote equity and access for all students through the use of community resources.

p. Use culturally inclusive language in all forms of communication.

q. Collaborate as needed to provide optimum services with other professionals such as special educators, school nurses, school social workers, school psychologists, college counselors/ admissions officers, physical therapists, occupational therapists, speech pathologists, administrators.

r. Work responsibly to remedy work environments that do not reflect the profession's ethics.

s. Work responsibly through the correct channels to try and remedy work conditions that do not reflect the ethics of the profession.

B.3. Responsibilities to Self

School counselors:

a. Have completed a counselor education program at an accredit-ed institution and earned a master's degree in school counseling.

b. Maintain membership in school counselor professional organizations to stay up to date on current research and to maintain professional competence in current school counseling issues and topics. School counselors maintain competence in their skills by utilizing current interventions and best practices.

c. Accept employment only for those positions for which they are qualified by education, training, supervised experience and state/national professional credentials.

d. Adhere to ethical standards of the profession and other official policy statements such as ASCA Position Statements and Role Statements, school board policies and relevant laws. When laws and ethical codes are in conflict school counselors work to adhere to both as much as possible.

e. Engage in professional development and personal growth throughout their careers. Professional development includes attendance at state and national conferences and reading journal articles. School counselors regularly attend training on school counselors' current legal and ethical responsibilities.

f. Monitor their emotional and physical health and practice wellness to ensure optimal professional effectiveness. School counselors seek physical or mental health support when needed to ensure professional competence.

g. Monitor personal behaviors and recognize the high standard of care a professional in this critical position of trust must main-tain on and off the job. School counselors are cognizant of and refrain from activity that may diminish their effectiveness within the school community.

h. Seek consultation and supervision from school counselors and other professionals who are knowledgeable of school counselors' ethical practices when ethical and professional questions arise.

i. Monitor and expand personal multicultural and social-justice advocacy awareness, knowledge and skills to be an effective culturally competent school counselor. Understand how prejudice, privilege and various forms of oppression based on ethnicity, ra-cial identity, age, economic status, abilities/disabilities, language, immigration status, sexual orientation, gender, gender identity expression, family type, religious/spiritual identity, appearance and living situations (e.g., foster care, homelessness, incarcera-tion) affect students and stakeholders.

j. Refrain from refusing services to students based solely on the school counselor's personally held beliefs or values rooted in one's religion, culture or ethnicity. School counselors respect the diversity of students and seek training and supervision when prejudice or biases interfere with providing comprehensive ser-vices to all students.

k. Work toward a school climate that embraces diversity and promotes academic, career and social/emotional development for all students.

l. Make clear distinctions between actions and statements (both verbal and written) made as a private individual and those made as a representative of the school counseling profession and of the school district.

m. Respect the intellectual property of others and adhere to copyright laws and correctly cite others' work when using it.

C. SCHOOL COUNSELOR ADMINISTRATORS/SUPERVISORS

School counselor administrators/supervisors support school counselors in their charge by:

a. Advocating both within and outside of their schools or districts for adequate resources to implement a comprehensive school counseling program and meet their students' needs.

b. Advocating for fair and open distribution of resources among programs supervised. An allocation procedure should be devel-oped that is nondiscriminatory, informed by data and consistent-ly applied.

c. Taking reasonable steps to ensure school and other resources are available to provide appropriate staff supervision and training.

d. Providing opportunities for professional development in cur-rent research related to school counseling practice and ethics.

e. Taking steps to eliminate conditions or practices in their schools or organizations that may violate, discourage or inter-fere with compliance with the ethics and laws related to the profession.

f. Monitoring school and organizational policies, regulations and procedures to ensure practices are consistent with the ASCA Ethical Standards for School Counselors.

D. SCHOOL COUNSELING INTERN SITE SUPERVISORS

Field/intern site supervisors:

a. Are licensed or certified school counselors and/or have an understanding of comprehensive school counseling programs and the ethical practices of school counselors.

b. Have the education and training to provide clinical supervi-sion. Supervisors regularly pursue continuing education activities on both counseling and supervision topics and skills.

c. Use a collaborative model of supervision that is on-going and includes, but is not limited to, the following activities: promot-ing professional growth, supporting best practices and ethical practice, assessing supervisee performance and developing plans for improvement, consulting on specific cases and assisting in the development of a course of action.

d. Are culturally competent and consider cultural factors that may have an impact on the supervisory relationship.

e. Do not engage in supervisory relationships with individuals with whom they have the inability to remain objective. Such individuals include, but are not limited to, family members and close friends.

f. Are competent with technology used to perform supervisory responsibilities and online supervision, if applicable. Supervisors protect all electronically transmitted confidential information.

g. Understand there are differences in face-to face and virtual communication (e.g., absence of verbal and nonverbal cues) that may have an impact on virtual supervision. Supervisors educate supervisees on how to communicate electronically to prevent and avoid potential problems.

h. Provide information about how and when virtual supervisory services will be utilized. Reasonable access to pertinent applica-tions should be provided to school counselors.

i. Ensure supervisees are aware of policies and procedures related to supervision and evaluation and provide due-process procedures if supervisees request or appeal their evaluations.

j. Ensure performance evaluations are completed in a timely, fair and considerate manner, using data when available and based on clearly stated criteria.

k. Use evaluation tools measuring the competence of school counseling interns. These tools should be grounded in state and national school counseling standards. In the event no such tool is available in the school district, the supervisor seeks out rele-vant evaluation tools and advocates for their use.

l. Are aware of supervisee limitations and communicate concerns to the university/college supervisor in a timely manner.

m. Assist supervisees in obtaining remediation and professional development as necessary.

n. Contact university/college supervisors to recommend dismiss-al when supervisees are unable to demonstrate competence as a school counselor as defined by the ASCA School Counselor Competencies and state and national standards. Supervisors consult with school administrators and document recommenda-tions to dismiss or refer a supervisee for assistance. Supervisors ensure supervisees are aware of such decisions and the resources available to them. Supervisors document all steps taken.

E. MAINTENANCE OF STANDARDS

When serious doubt exists as to the ethical behavior of a col-league(s) the following procedures may serve as a guide:

a. School counselors consult with professional colleagues to discuss the potentially unethical behavior and to see if the professional colleague views the situation as an ethical violation. School counselors understand mandatory reporting in their respective district and states.

b. School counselors discuss and seek resolution directly with the colleague whose behavior is in question unless the behav-ior is unlawful, abusive, egregious or dangerous, in which case proper school or community authorities are contacted.

c. If the matter remains unresolved at the school, school district or state professional practice/standards commission, referral for review and appropriate action should be made in the following sequence:

- State school counselor association
- American School Counselor Association (Complaints should be submitted in hard copy to the ASCA Ethics Committee, c/o the Executive Director, American School Counselor Associa-tion, 1101 King St., Suite 310, Alexandria, VA 22314.)

F. ETHICAL DECISION MAKING

When faced with an ethical dilemma, school counselors and school counseling program directors/supervisors use an ethical decision-making model such as Solutions to Ethical Problems in Schools (STEPS) (Stone, 2001):

a. Define the problem emotionally and intellectually

b. Apply the ASCA Ethical Standards for School Counselors and the law

c. Consider the students' chronological and developmental levels d.

Consider the setting, parental rights and minors' rights

e. Apply the ethical principles of beneficence, autonomy, nonma-leficence, loyalty and justice

f. Determine potential courses of action and their consequences g.

Evaluate the selected action

h. Consult

i. Implement the course of action

GLOSSARY OF TERMS

Advocate
a person who speaks, writes or acts to promote the well-being of students, parents/guardians and the school counseling profession. School counselors advocate to close the information, opportunity, intervention and attainment gaps for all students.

Assent
to demonstrate agreement when a student is not competent to give informed consent to counseling or other services the school counselor is providing.

Assessment
collecting in-depth information about a person to develop a comprehensive plan that will guide the collaborative counseling and service provision process.

Boundaries
something that indicates or affixes an extent or limits.

Breach
disclosure of information given in private or confidential communication such as information given during counseling.

Competence
the quality of being competent; adequacy; possession of required skill, knowledge, qualification or capacity.

Confidentiality
the ethical duty of school counselors to responsibly protect a student's private communications shared in counseling.

Conflict of Interest
a situation in which a school counselor stands to personally profit from a decision involving a student.

Consent
permission, approval or agreement; compliance.

Consultation
a professional relationship in which individuals meet to seek ad-vice, information and/or deliberation to address a student's need.

Conventional Parameters
general agreement or accepted standards regarding limits, boundaries or guidelines.

Cultural Sensitivity
a set of skills enabling you to know, understand and value the similarities and differences in people and modify your behavior to be most effective and respectful of students and families and to deliver programs that fit the needs of diverse learners.

Data Dialogues
inquiry with others around student information to uncover ineq-uities, promote informed investigations and assist in understand-ing the meaning of data and the next steps to have an impact on data.

Data Informed
accessing data, applying meaning to it and using data to have an impact on student success.

Developmental Level/Age
the age of an individual determined by degree of emotional, mental and physiological maturity as compared with typical behaviors and characteristics of that chronological age.

Disclosure
the act or an instance of exposure or revelation.

Diversity
the inclusion of individuals representing more than one national origin, gender/gender identity, color, religion, socio-economic stratum, sexual orientation and the intersection of cultural and social identities.

Dual Relationship
a relationship in which a school counselor is concurrently participating in two or more roles with a student.

Empathy
the action of understanding, being aware of, being sensitive to and vicariously experiencing the feelings, thoughts and experi-ence of another without having the feelings, thoughts and expe-rience fully communicated in an objectively explicit manner.

Emancipated Minor
a minor who is legally freed from control by his or her parents or guardians, and the parents or guardians are freed from any and all responsibility toward the child.

Encryption
process of putting information into a coded form to control and limit access to authorized users.

Ethics
the norms and principles of conduct and philosophy governing the profession.

Ethical Behavior
actions defined by standards of conduct for the profession.

Ethical Obligation
a standard or set of standards defining the course of action for the profession.

Ethical Rights
the fundamental normative rules about what is allowed of people or owed to people, according to some legal system, social convention or ethical theory.

Feasible
capable of being done, effected or accomplished.

Gender Expression
the ways in which students manifest masculinity or femininity in terms of clothing, communication patterns and interests, which may or may not reflect the student's gender identity.

Gender Identity
One's personal experience of one's own gender. When one's gender identity and biological sex are not congruent, the student may identify as transsexual or transgender.

Harassment
the act of systematic and/or continued unwanted disturbing or troubling persecution.

Informed Consent
assisting students in acquiring an understanding of the limits of confidentiality, the benefits, facts and risks of entering into a counseling relationship.

Intervention
to provide modifications, materials, advice, aids, services or other forms of support to have a positive impact on the outcome or course of a condition.

Legal Mandates
a judicial command or precept issued by a court or magistrate, directing proper behavior to enforce a judgment, sentence or decree.

Legal Rights
those rights bestowed onto a person by a given legal system.

Mandatory Reporting
the legal requirement to report to authorities.

Minors
persons under the age of 18 years unless otherwise designated by statute or regulation.

Perception
A mental image or awareness of environment through a physical sensation. A capacity for understanding or a result of an obser-vation.

Peer Helper
peer-to-peer interaction in which individuals who are of approx-imately the same age take on a helping role assisting students who may share related values, experiences and lifestyles.

Peer Support
programs that enhance the effectiveness of the school counseling program while increasing outreach and raising student aware-ness of services.

Privacy
the right of an individual to keep oneself and one's personal information free from unauthorized disclosure.

Privileged Communication
conversation that takes places within the context of a protected relationship, such as that between an attorney and client, a hus-band and wife, a priest and penitent, a doctor and patient and, in some states, a school counselor and a student.

Professional Development
the process of improving and increasing capabilities through access to education and training opportunities.

Relationship
a connection, association or involvement.

Risk Assessment
a systematic process of evaluating potential risks

School Counseling Supervisor
a qualified professional who provides guidance, teaching and support for the professional development of school counselors and school counseling candidates.

Serious and Foreseeable
when a reasonable person can anticipate significant and harmful possible consequences.

Sole-Possession Records
exempted from the definition of educational records and the protection of FERPA, are records used only as a personal mem-ory aid that are kept in the sole possession of the maker of the record and are not accessible or revealed to any other person except a temporary substitute for the maker of the record and provide only professional opinion or personal observations.

Stakeholder
a person or group that shares an investment or interest in an endeavor.

Supervision
a collaborative relationship in which one person promotes and/ or evaluates the development of another.

Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972
a law that demands that no person in the United States shall, on the basis of sex, be excluded from participation in, be denied the benefits of or be subjected to discrimination under any education program or activity receiving federal financial assistance.

Virtual/Distance Counseling
counseling by electronic means.



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